

Secrets of Search Engines Revealed - CIA

Remember the 'eye in the sky'? This is it. Apologies to those with jumpy minds, this isn't a classified document released by the Central Intelligence Agency. CIA stands for Crawling, Indexing and Algorithms, the three act play behind any search engine. The search engine sends out bots (a.k.a. spiders) to Crawl the web. These bots are basically scripts that go from page to page and link to link, building an Index of whatever they find. They start crawling with a list of known urls and when they come across a new link on a page, it is added to the list and crawled over later.

The Index is a massive compilation of all the words that the bot comes across, along with information like their position on the page, related attributes and tags, etc. Crawling is a continuous process, because things change really quickly on the internet, and search engines like to keep up. Now when someone uses a search engine, the part that takes the query and returns results from the Index is the Algorithm. These algorithms take into account a multitude of factors to determine the most relevant results, given a user's query. Therefore, the Algorithm is what really decides the ranking of the pages. Again, different search engines have their own proprietary algorithms and thus often return different results for the same query.

With a rhyme this chapter begun, perhaps it should end with one. Learn this, for to learn you came: Fame is the main name of the game. If you think you are the best, making it to the top of the search rankings is your test. Here's a hint for the



This spider does NOT work for Google or Bing

whole class: you don't really have to be the best to pass. There's no guarantee, but all you have to do, is read this Fast Track and not forget to follow through.

So now that you have an idea of what SEO is, why should you care? Well, that's what the next chapter is all about! Dive right in! **d**